MEREDITH POWERS FRANCO

(née Meredith Dentes Powers)

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy **Master of Education** 2023, 2019; GPA: 3.98	University of Virginia Clinical and School Psychology (APA/NASP accredited) *Dissertation Title: Culturally responsive practice in PK-12 classrooms: Identification and validation of discrete indicators*
Master of Education 2015; GPA: 4.00	University of Maryland, College Park Special Education
Bachelor of Science 2014; GPA: 3.88	University of Maryland, College Park Special Education major, Human Development minor *Academic honors for all undergraduate semesters*

LICENSURE

Licensed Clinical Psychologist (ID: 07310)
Authority: Maryland Board of Examiners of Psychologists
LCP: 11/7/2024 - 3/31/2026

Nationally Certified School Psychologist (ID: 66992*)*
Authority: National School Psychology Certification Board
NCSP: 1/11/2024 - 1/31/2027

Maryland Educator License (ID: 1001676356)
Authority: Maryland State Department of Education
Initial Professional License (IPL): 7/1/2025 – 6/30/2030
PEC (Professional Eligibility Certificate): 7/1/2020 - 6/30/2025
SPC I (Standard Professional I): 7/1/2015 - 6/30/2020
Certification Areas:
Specialist: School Psychologist
Teaching: Generic Special Education: Grades 1 – 8
Teaching: Severely/Profoundly Disabled: Birth – 21
Teaching: Elementary General Education: Grades 1 – 6

FELLOWSHIPS & GRANT AWARDS

NSF Emerging Scholar – *$500* Awarded May 2022

National Science Foundation (NSF)
Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)
Selected by the NSF and SRCD to participate in the NSF Mentee-Mentor Emerging Scholars Program (2022-2023)

Start with Equity Fellowship – *$10,000* Awarded Aug. 2020
Children's Equity Project at Arizona State University
Fellowship to prepare the next generation of changemakers in early childhood (ages 0 – 10) policy and research

Marjorie Hare Andrews Fellowship – *$1,000* Awarded Apr. 2020
Curry School of Education Foundation
Awarded to a student engaged in empirical, quantitative research in areas that will have an impact on educational practice or maximize the potential of children

Power, Violence and Inequality Fellowship – *$2,000* Awarded Oct. 2019
UVA Power, Violence and Inequality Collective (PVI)
Funding to support graduate research on the topic of power-based violence

CTSI-CN Award Program – *$10,000* Awarded Jan. 2017
Clinical and Translational Science Institute at Children's National
Lead grant writer (UL1TR001876 and KL2TR001877); Small research grant funding supported by NIH National Center for Advancing Translational Sciences

HONORS & DISCTINCTIONS

Outstanding Dissertation in School Psychology Award Awarded Aug. 2024
American Psychological Association (APA), Division 16
Awarded for a dissertation which merits special recognition and which has the potential to contribute to the science and practice of school psychology

2022 Student Leader Champion Awarded Oct. 2022
National Association of School Psychologists (NASP)
Recognized as a student champion for initiatives and programming that further social justice and equity within their training program and the field of school psychology

Graduate Student of the Year Awarded Sep. 2021
Virginia Academy of School Psychologists (VASP)
Recognized for excelling in the areas of leadership, scholarship, clinical skills, and commitment to social justice and culturally responsive practice

Honor Society Member Inducted Nov. 2020
The Raven Society – University of Virginia
Recognized for scholastic excellence and commitment to the University community

Maryland Teacher of Promise Awarded Mar. 2015
Maryland State Department of Education (MSDE)

Recognized as "most promising pre-service educator" representing the University of Maryland in state-wide ceremony

Outstanding Undergraduate Student Award / Student Marshal Awarded May 2014
College of Education, University of Maryland
Student marshals are honored for outstanding academic achievement and contributions to student life

Merrill Presidential Scholar Awarded Nov. 2013
The Merrill Presidential Scholars Program
Awarded to the University of Maryland's most successful senior students and their mentors

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Scientist, August 2024 – Present
Postdoctoral Research Associate, July 2023 – August 2024
Youth-Nex | Center to Promote Effective Youth Development
School of Education and Human Development
University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA
Supervisors: Jessika Bottiani, PhD and Catherine Bradshaw, PhD

"Development and Validation of the Culturally and Racial Equity Sustaining (CARES) Classroom Assessment System"
Principal Investigators: Jessika Bottiani, PhD
Agency: Institute of Education Sciences (IES)
Grant Number: R305A220212
Period 07/01/2022 – 06/30/2026
Description: Working a study co-investigator leading the classroom observation workgroup for an IES Measurement project funded to develop an assessment system of three multi-informant, psychometrically validated instruments (teacher-, student-, and observer-report). The purpose of this project is to extend, refine, and validate a measurement system to assess culturally- and racial equity-sustaining (CARES) practices in the classroom, leveraging a model that was previously developed in prior IES Exploration and related IES Development and Efficacy projects.

Predoctoral Research Intern, June 2022 – June 2023
National Center for School Mental Health
University of Maryland School of Medicine, Baltimore, MD
Supervisor: Nancy Lever, PhD

"Improving the Quality of School-based Universal Prevention Services for Trauma-Exposed Youth in Baltimore City"
Principal Investigators: Nancy Lever, PhD and Jennifer Cox, LCSW-C
Agency: Empowering Health @ United HealthCare Services, Inc.
Grant Number: N/A - "United HealthCare Social Responsibility Grant"
Period: 8/1/2022 – 7/31/2023
Description: Managed a yearlong pilot project evaluating the implementation of a Tier 2 prevention program for second through fifth grade students in Baltimore City Title I

Schools, focused on collaboration between general education teachers and school-based mental health clinicians. The project was supported by United Healthcare's *Empowering Health* initiative, which supports community-based organizations in expanding access to care and addressing the social determinants of health for uninsured individuals and underserved communities.

Doctoral Research Assistant, August 2018 – July 2022
Preventive Interventions Team: Collaborative Research on Engagement and Wellbeing
School of Education and Human Development, University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA
Supervisors: Catherine Bradshaw, PhD, and Jessika Bottiani, PhD

"The R-CITY Model: Reducing Racism and Violence through Collaborative Intervention with Teachers and Youth"
Principal Investigators: Jessika Bottiani, PhD and Catherine Bradshaw, PhD
Agency: National Institute on Minority Health and Health Disparities (NIMHD)
Grant Number: R01MD013808
Period: 4/01/2019 – 11/30/2024
Description: Led the development of a new classroom observation instrument (outcome measure), observer trainings, and teacher intervention resources for a student-teacher intervention called the R-CITY Model: Reducing Racism and Violence through Collaborative Intervention with Teachers and Youth.

"Testing the Efficacy of Double Check: A Cultural Proficiency Professional Development Model in Middle Schools"
Principal Investigators: Catherine Bradshaw, PhD and Katrina Debnam, PhD
Agency: Institute of Education Sciences (IES)
Grant Number: R305A150221
Period: 7/1/2015 – 6/30/2019
Description: The Double Check Student Engagement and Cultural Responsiveness Program was developed through a U.S. Department of Education Institute of Education Sciences grant to promote equitable school climate experiences among students of color by improving teachers' use of culturally responsive school and classroom practices, thereby also reducing teachers' disparate discipline referrals for Black and Latinx youth. In particular, our research focuses on a model of cultural responsiveness with five core components: Connection to Curriculum, Authentic Relationships, Reflective Thinking, Effective Communication, and Sensitivity to Students' Culture (i.e., CARES). Key questions of interest have to do with how we define, operationalize, and measure these five core components of culturally responsive practices.

Graduate Research Mentor, June 2019 – July 2019
Virginia's Summer Undergraduate Research Program
University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA

Served as a research mentor in the University of Virginia's Summer Undergraduate Research Program (SURP). SURP is a 10-week internship that provides undergraduates from underrepresented racial-ethnic groups with valuable research and professional development experience under the guidance of UVA faculty and graduate students conducting education research. In the role as a graduate research mentor, I supported two

aspiring researchers in crafting their research questions, conducting analyses, composing a conference presentation, and presenting their findings at a national research conference in July 2019

Clinical Research Coordinator I, September 2016 – June 2018
Center for Autism Spectrum Disorders (CASD)
Children's National Health System, Washington, DC
Supervisors: Lauren Kenworthy, PhD, and Laura Anthony, PhD

"Characterization of Executive Function Dimensions Across Pediatric Psychiatric Disorders"
Principal Investigators: Madison Berl, PhD, Lauren Kenworthy, PhD, and Chandan Vaidya, PhD
Agency: The National Institutes of Mental Health (NIMH)
Grant Number: 1R01MH110512-01
Period: 07/19/2016 – 04/30/2021

"A Community-Based Executive Function Intervention for Low-Income Children with ADHD and ASD"
Principal Investigator: Laura Anthony, PhD
Agency: Patient-Centered Outcomes Research Institute (PCORI)
Grant Number: AD-1304-7379
Period: 11/01/2013 – 10/31/2017

"A Nationwide Stakeholder Survey of Best Practices for Community-Based Intervention Dissemination & Implementation"
Principal Investigator: Lauren Kenworthy, PhD
Agency: Clinical and Translational Science Institute at Children's National, *supported by the NIH National Center for Advancing Translational Sciences*
Grant Numbers: UL1TR001876 and KL2TR001877
Period: 01/23/2017 – 5/31/2019

"Behavioral and Neural Outcomes of a New Executive Function Treatment for Transition-age Youth with ASD"
Principal Investigator: Cara Pugliese, PhD
Agency: Children's Research Institute – NIMH K23 Mentored Career Award
Grant Number: K23MH110612
Period: 07/11/2016 – 6/30/2020

"Effectiveness Trial of On Target for Life in Adolescents with Autism Spectrum Disorders"
Principal Investigator: John Strang, PsyD
Agency: Organization for Autism Research
Grant Number: N/A
Period: 8/20/2015 – 12/31/2017

Family Recruitment Specialist, March 2013 – January 2014
Infant and Child Studies Consortium
University of Maryland, College Park, MD
Supervisors: Meredith L. Rowe, PhD, and Geetha Ramani, PhD

Research Assistant, August 2012 – May 2013
Department of Human Development and Quantitative Methodologies (HDQM)
University of Maryland, College Park, MD
Supervisor: David Miele, PhD

Articles Published in Peer-Reviewed Journals

Bottiani, J. H, Kaihoi, C **Franco, M. P.,** Pas, E. T., Debnam, K. J., Somerville, K., & Bradhsaw, C. P. (in preparation) Randomized controlled trial of the R-CITY multi-component equity-focused social emotional learning program: Effects on teacher practices and early adolescent outcome. *Prevention Science.*

Franco, M. P., Rouiller, S., Bradshaw, C. P., Pas, E. T., Pandey, T. Kaihoi, C. A., & J. H., Bottiani (under review). Coaching teachers to implement equity and social-emotional learning focused curricula in the classroom: Insights from a randomized controlled trial. *Journal of Educational and Psychological Consultation.*

Bottiani, J. H, **Franco, M. P.,** Henderson Smith, L., Aguayo, D., Kaihoi, C. A., & Debnam, K. J., (under review). CARES360: A framework for teacher capacity-building on culturally sustaining and racially equitable classroom practices. *Journal of School Psychology.*

Nygaard, M. A., Mullin, A., **Franco, M. P.,** Goodwin, A. K. B., Cox, J., & Lever, N. (under review). An ecological examination of employing cultural humility to adapt a classroom-based trauma-focused prevention program. *School Psychology International.*

Franco, M. P., Bottiani, J. H., Debnam, K. J., Bonifay, W., Pandey, T., Karras, J., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2024). The CARES classroom observation tool: Psychometrics of an observational measure of culturally responsive practices. *Journal of School Psychology*, *107*, 101381. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jsp.2024.101381

Franco, M. P., Bottiani, J. H., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2024). Assessing teachers' culturally responsive classroom practice in PK–12 schools: A systematic review of teacher-, student-, and observer-report measures. *Review of Educational Research*, *94*(5), 743–798. https://doi.org/10.3102/00346543231208720

Franco, M. P., Bottiani, J. H., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2024). Teachers' structuring of culturally responsive social relations and secondary students' experience of warm demand. *Contemporary Educational Psychology.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cedpsych.2023.102241

Nygaard, M. A., Schmidt, C., **Franco, M.P.,** Cox, J., & Lever, N. (2024). Tier 1.5 as a Strategy for Trauma Support in Schools. *American Journal of Health Education*, *56*(1), 21–35. https://doi.org/10.1080/19325037.2024.2422067

Henderson Smith, L. H., **Franco, M. P.,** Callahan, K., & Bottiani, J. H. (2023). Student and teacher perspectives on culturally responsive practices in a tribal school. *Journal of American Indian Education 62*(1), 33-61. https://dx.doi.org/10.1353/jaie.2023.a934664.

Henderson Smith, L., **Franco, M. P.,** & Bottiani, J. H. (2023). "We're teachers right, we're not social workers?" Teacher perspectives on student mental health in a tribal school. *School Mental Health*. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12310-023-09607-9

Cook, K. M., You, X., Cherry, J. B. C., Merchant, J. S., Skapek, M., **Powers, M. D.,** Pugliese, C. E., Kenworthy, L., & Vaidya, C. J. (2021) Neural correlates of schema-dependent episodic memory and association with behavioral flexibility in autism spectrum disorders and typical development. *Journal of Neurodevelopmental Disorders.* https://doi.org/10.1186/s11689-021-09388-9

Strang, J. F., Knauss, M., van der Miesen, A., McGuire, J. K., Kenworthy, L., Caplan, R., ... **Powers, M. D.,** & Anthony, L.G. (2020). A clinical program for transgender and gender-diverse neurodiverse/autistic adolescents developed through community-based participatory design. *Journal of Clinical Child & Adolescent Psychology*, 1-16. https://doi.org/10.1080/15374416.2020.1731817

Strang, J. F., **Powers, M. D.**, Knauss, M., Sibarium, E., Leibowitz, S., Kenworthy, L., Sadikova, E., Wyss, S., Willing, L., Caplan, R., Pervez, N., Nowak, J., Gohari, D., Gomez-Lobo, V., Call, D., & Anthony, L.G. (2018). "They thought it was an obsession": Trajectories and perspectives of autistic transgender and gender-diverse adolescents. *Journal of Autism and Developmental Disorders.* https://doi.org/10.1007/s10803-018-3723-6

Chapters in Edited Volumes

Bottiani, J. H., Henderson Smith, L. J., **Franco, M. P.,** Bradshaw, C. P., & Debnam, K. J. (2023). Triangulation of data: Using student, teacher, parent, and observer data to improve school climate. In T.P. LaSalle (Ed.), *Creating an inclusive school climate: A school psychology model for supporting marginalized students*. Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003400424

Editor Reviewed Publications

Franco, M. P. (2023). *Culturally responsive practice in PK-12 classrooms: Identification and validation of discrete indicators* [Doctoral dissertation, University of Virginia]. LibraETD: Online Archive of University of Virginia Scholarship. https://doi.org/10.18130/43f2-xx11

Powers, M. D. & Bottiani, J. H. (2019, October 29) Review of the book *Creating safe, equitable, engaging schools: A comprehensive, evidence-based approach to supporting students*

by D. Osher, D. Moroney, and S. Williamson, Eds.*;* ID Number: 23125*. Teachers College Record.* https://www.tcrecord.org/Content.asp?ContentId=23125

Powers, M. D. (2012). Addressing Autism. *Interpolations: A Journal of Academic Writing, 5*.

Chaired Symposia at Professional Meetings

Franco, M. P. (Chair). (2023, December 6). *Preventative Interventions: Scaling Up School-Based Interventions for Universal Settings* [Symposium] 2023 Annual Conference on Advancing School Mental Health, New Orleans, LA.

Oral Presentations at Professional Meetings

Franco, M. P., Newman, C., Pandey, T., Birchfield, K., and Kaihoi. C. A. (2024, April 20). Seeing the forest and the trees: Teachers' perceptions on process and content of a measure of culturally sustaining and racially equitable practices. In J. H. Bottiani (Chair), *The CARES360 Assessment: A Tool for Building Culturally Sustaining and Equitable Classrooms.* [Symposium]. 2024 Annual Meeting of the Society for Research on Adolescence. Chicago, Illinois.

Aguayo, D., Henderson Smith, L., **Franco, M. P.,** & Bottiani, J. (2024, April 20). Parents' perceptions on a multi-informant assessment tool for teachers to gain feedback on their use of culturally sustaining and racially equitable practices. In J. H. Bottiani (Chair), *The CARES360 Assessment: A Tool for Building Culturally Sustaining and Equitable Classrooms.* [Symposium]. 2024 Annual Meeting of the Society for Research on Adolescence. Chicago, Illinois.

Franco, M. P., Schmidt, C., Cox, J., & Lever, N. (2023, December 6). The Case for "Tier 1.5": Leveraging School-Based Mental Health Clinicians in the Scaling-Up of Trauma-Focused Intervention for the Tier 1 Setting. In **M. P. Franco** (Chair), *Preventative Interventions: Scaling Up School-Based Interventions for Universal Settings.* [Symposium]. 2023 Annual Conference on Advancing School Mental Health. New Orleans, LA.

Kaihoi, C., Reaves, S., **Franco, M.**, Henderson Smith, L., & Carter, T. (Presenters; 2023). *Challenges and opportunities for measuring cultural responsiveness and racially equitable practices in school settings* [On-Demand Paper Presentation]. 2023 Annual Conference on Advancing School Mental Health. New Orleans, LA.

Franco, M. P., Bottiani, J. H., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2023, March 23-25). Exploring Indicators of Consequential Validity Among CRP Measures in PK-12 U.S. Classrooms. In L. López (Chair), *Use, Analysis, and Development of Classroom Assessments with a focus on Culturally Responsive Educational Practices* [Symposium]. 2023 Society for Research in Child Development. Salt Lake City, Utah.

Powers, M. D., Bottiani, J. H., Karras-Jean Gilles, J., Suárez-Orozco, C., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2022, May 2). Observational assessments of culturally responsive teaching: Leveraging the Measures of Effective Teaching (MET) study. In J. H. Bottiani (Chair), *Observational measurement of teachers' culturally responsive classroom practices* [Symposium]. The

Construction of the 'Other': Development, Consequences, and Applied Implications of Prejudice and Discrimination, SRCD Special Topic Meeting 2022. Rio Grande, Puerto Rico.

Powers, M. D., Bottiani, J. H., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2021, October 14-15). Cultivating warm demand: Culturally responsive practices as a tool to facilitate students' perceptions of White teachers as warm demanders. In S. Lindstrom Johnson (Chair), *The intersection between culturally responsive teaching practices and student-teacher relationships (A Chicken and Egg Situation)* [Symposium]. 2021 Annual Conference on Advancing School Mental Health. Virtual Conference.

Powers, M. D., Bottiani, J. H., Debnam, K. J., Bonifay, W., Bradshaw, C. P., & Herman, K. (2021, June 2-4). Challenges measuring teachers' culturally responsive practices in the classroom. In K. J. Debnam (Chair), *Defining and measuring culturally responsive practices in schools* [Symposium]. The Society for Prevention Research 29th Annual Meeting. Virtual Conference.

Powers, M. D., Simmons, S. C., Sadikova, E., Hernandez, B. E., & Duran, C. A. K. (2021, June 2-4). Exploring the value of parent-led cultural socialization for social development of young children living in low-income rural communities. In N. Riggs & K. J. Debnam (Chairs) *Sixteenth Annual SPR Sloboda and Bukoski Cup* [Research competition; team captain]. The Society for Prevention Research 29th Annual Meeting. Virtual Conference.

Powers, M. D., Bottiani, J. H., Debnam, K. D., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2020, October 29). *Measurement of culturally responsive practices in PreK-12 classrooms: Past, present, and future measurement approaches.* In L. J. Henderson (Chair) *Increasing teacher culturally responsive practices through Double Chec*k [Pre-recorded Symposium]. 2020 Annual Conference on Advancing School Mental Health. Virtual Conference.

Powers, M. D., Bottiani, J. H., & Bradshaw, C. P. (2020, May). Cultivating warm-demand: How teachers' use of culturally responsive practices relates to classroom climate. In C. P. Bradshaw (Chair), *Leveraging the classroom context to improve behavioral outcomes for students: Implications for coaching teachers* [Symposium]. The Society for Prevention Research 28th Annual Meeting. Washington, DC, United States. (Conference canceled)

Pugliese, C. E., Werner, M. A., Skapek, M. F., **Powers, M. D.**, Saldana, L., Anthony, L., & Kenworthy, L. (2020, May) Preliminary outcomes of a new school-based executive function treatment for transition-age youth with ASD [Paper presentation]. Annual Meeting of the International Society for Autism Research. Seattle, Washington, United States. (Conference canceled)

Powers, M. D., Knauss, M. Gohari, D., Anthony, L. G., Kenworthy, L., & Strang, J. F. (2018, May 9-12). Gender histories, life experiences, and future plans and hopes of gender dysphoric autistic youth: A framework analysis. In J. Strang (Chair), *The co-occurrence of autism and gender dysphoria or gender incongruence* [Symposium]. 2018 Annual Meeting of the International Society for Autism Research. Rotterdam, Netherlands.

Ratto, A. B., Anthony, L. G., **Powers, M.**, Verbalis, A., Seese, S., & Kenworthy, L. (2018, May 9-12). Effects of dual-language exposure on language and executive function in children with ASD and ADHD [Paper presentation]. Annual Meeting of the International Society for Autism Research. Rotterdam, Netherlands.

Anthony, L. G., Anthony, B., Verbalis, A., Naiman, D., Ratto, A. B., Seese, S., Safer-Lichtenstein, J., Skapek, M., **Powers, M.**, Troxel, M., & Kenworthy, L. (2018, May 9-12). An exploration of possible moderators in an addressing disparities comparative effectiveness trial for elementary students with ASD or ADHD. In A. Gruber (Chair), *Psychosocial and demographic moderators of intervention outcomes for youth and young adults with ASD* [Symposium]. Annual Meeting of the International Society for Autism Research. Rotterdam, Netherlands.

Invited Presentations

Powers, M. D. (2019, November). Guest Panelist for the Curry Parent Leadership Council. In R. C. Pianta (Chair), *Social-emotional challenges facing adolescence.* Curry School of Education and Human Development, University of Virginia. Charlottesville, VA.

Powers, M. D. & Sadikova, E. (2019, November). Co-Panelist for the Department of Human Services Monthly Diversity Speaker Series. *Clinical considerations for youth with co-occurring autism and gender dysphoria.* Curry School of Education and Human Development, University of Virginia. Charlottesville, VA.

Powers, M. D. (2017, November). *A pre-service teacher's guide to supporting students with ASD.* Presentation to Teacher Education Association of Maryland Students. College Park, MD.

Powers, M. D. (2016, April). Alumni Panelist for Teacher Education Association of Maryland Students. In J. Froh (Chair), *First-year teachers' experience in the classroom.* College of Education, University of Maryland. College Park, MD.

Poster Presentations at Professional Meetings

Franco, M. P., Schmidt, C., Cox, J., Lever, N. (2023, April 20). *Improving the Quality of School-based Universal Prevention Services for Trauma-Exposed Youth in Baltimore City* [Poster presentation]. Annual Research Day, Department of Psychiatry, University of Maryland School of Medicine. Baltimore, MD, United States.

Powers, M. D. & Capobianco, N. B. (2020, May). *Parent racial stress and child social-emotional competence in rural America* [Poster presentation]. The Construction of the 'Other': Development, Consequences, and Applied Implications of Prejudice and Discrimination, SRCD Special Topic Meeting 2020. Rio Grande, Puerto Rico. (Conference canceled)

Handsman, R., **Powers**, **M. D.**, Kenworthy, L., Anthony, L., & Pugliese, C. E. (2020, May). *The utility of classroom observations as a tool for measuring executive functioning skills in adolescents: Validity and sensitivity to treatment change* [Poster presentation]. Annual Meeting

of the International Society for Autism Research. Seattle, WA, United States. (Conference canceled)

Cook, K. M., Cherry, J. B., You, X., Merchant, K., Skapek, M. F., **Powers, M. D.**, Pugliese, C. E., Kenworthy, L., and Vaidya, C. (2020, May). *Neural corelates of schema-dependent encoding in children with autism spectrum disorders: The role of behavioral flexibility* [Poster presentation]. Annual Meeting of the International Society for Autism Research. Seattle, WA, United States. (Conference canceled)

You, X., Merchant, J., Flaharty, K., Cherry, J., Skapek, M., **Powers, M.**, Clinton, R., Jeppsen, C., Rau, S., Myrick, M., Rosch, K., Nebel, M. B., Mostofsky, S., Berl, M., Kenworthy, L., & Vaidya, C. (2019, June 9 - 13). *Higher striatal and salience network integration underlies disinhibition in a transdiagnostic sample* [Poster presentation]. Organization for Human Brain Mapping Conference. Rome, Italy.

Troxel, M., **Powers, M.,** Myrick, Y., Strang, J., Pugliese, C, Kenworthy, L., & Anthony, L. (2019, May 1 - 4). *What services are families of children with executive function challenges getting? What do parents say they want?* [Poster presentation]. Annual Meeting of the International Society for Autism Research. Montreal, Canada.

Pugliese, C., Skapek, M. F., **Powers, M. D.**, Saldana, L., Anthony, L., & Kenworthy, L. (2019, May 1 - 4). *Preliminary outcomes of a new executive function treatment for transition-age youth with ASD* [Poster presentation]. 2019 Annual Meeting of the International Society for Autism Research. Montreal, Canada.

Powers, M. D., Anthony, L. G., Safer-Lichtenstein, J., Verbalis, A. D., Seese, S. & Kenworthy, L. (2019, March 22). *Understanding negativity in the classroom: Which executive functions are behind negative student behaviors?* [Poster presentation]. 2019 Society for Research in Child Development Biennial Meeting. Baltimore, MD, United States.

Powers, M. D., Kenworthy, L., Myrick, Y., Troxel, M., & Anthony, L.G. (2018, November 17). *What's Missing In Your Toolbox?: A lack of execution function interventions in U.S. schools* [Poster presentation]. 52nd Annual Convention of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies. Washington, DC, United States.

Miller, M., Anthony, L.G., Ratto, A., **Powers, M. D.**, Troxel, M., Myrick, Y., Pugliese, C., & Kenworthy, L. (2018, November 16). *Exploring contributors to parents' ideal and realistic goals for involvement in school trainings* [Poster presentation]. 52nd Annual Convention of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies. Washington, DC, United States.

Powers, M. D., Kenworthy, L., Anthony, L., Verbalis, A. D., Seese, S., Safer-Lichtenstein, J., & Ratto, A. (2018, February 15). *Linguistic Diversity in neurodevelopmental disorders: Dual language exposure relates to cognitive flexibility in children with ASD but not ADHD* [Poster presentation]. 46th Annual Meeting of the International Neuropsychological Society. Washington, DC, United States.

Ratto, A. B., Anthony, L. G., **Powers, M.**, Verbalis, A., Seese, S., and Safer-Lichtenstein, J., & Kenworthy, L. (2018, February 15). *Differential effects of dual language exposure on language and nonverbal problem-solving in children with ASD and ADHD* [Poster presentation]. 46th Annual Meeting of the International Neuropsychological Society. Washington, DC, United States.

Skapek, M., Pugliese, C., Seese, S., **Powers, M.**, Kenworthy, L., & Strang, J. (2018, February 15). *Anxiety relates to interference associated with planning and flexibility weaknesses in youth with ASD* [Poster presentation]. 46th Annual Meeting of the International Neuropsychological Society. Washington, DC, United States.

Powers, M. D., Ratto, A., Anthony, B. J., Kenworthy, L., Safer-Lichtenstein, J., Seese, S., Verbalis, A. D., & Anthony, L. G. (2017, November 18). *Racial disproportionality in the classroom: Why do we see Black students with ADHD as having more executive function problems?* [Poster presentation]. 51st Annual Convention of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies. San Diego, CA, United States.

Skapek, M., Strang, J. F., Seese, S., **Powers, M.**, Kenworthy, L., & Pugliese, C. (2017, November 17). *The relationship between executive function and anxiety in adolescents with ASD* [Poster presentation]. 51st Annual Convention of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies Autism Spectrum and Developmental Disorders (AS/DD) SIG. San Diego, CA, United States.

Powers, M. D., Ratto, A., Anthony, B. J., Kenworthy, L., Safer-Lichtenstein, J., Seese, S., Verbalis, A. D., & Anthony, L. G. (2017, October 20). *Exploring gender & ethnicity bias in classroom ratings and observations of executive functioning* [Poster presentation]. 22nd Annual Conference on Advancing School Mental Health. Washington, DC, United States.

Feeney, K., **Powers, M.**, Layer-Whelan, S., Kromash, R., Hughes, C., James, D. & Felton, J. (2017, June 1). *Examining the impact of child externalizing behaviors on parental stress in families of children with an autism spectrum disorder* [Poster presentation]. Journal of Clinical Child and Adolescent Psychology Future Directions Forum. College Park, MD, United States.

Powers, M. D., Verbalis, A. D., Anthony, B. J., Kenworthy, L., Safer-Lichtenstein, J., Skapek, M., Limon, D., Seese, S. & Anthony, L. G. (2017, May 26). *Who is sitting on the sidelines?: Sports participation disparities in low-income children with ADHD* [Poster presentation]. 2017 Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention. Boston, MA, United States.

Powers, M. D., Tiplady, K. M., Anthony, B. J., Kenworthy, L., Verbalis, A. D., Kraper, C. K., Limon, D., Seese, S., Safer-Lichtenstein, J., Skapek, M. F. & Anthony, L. G. (2017, May 13). *Factors that drive access to services for children with neurodevelopmental disorders in low income populations* [Poster presentation]. International Meeting for Autism Research. San Francisco, CA, United States.

Conference & Travel Awards

Brenda Holliday Loyd Award – *$2,750* Awarded Mar. 2022
School of Education and Human Development Foundation
Funding to present first-authored student research at a national conference

Early Career Preventionists Network Travel Award Awarded May 2021
Society for Prevention Research (SPR)
Exemption of registration fees to present at SPR Virtual 29th Annual Meeting

Dean's Travel Fellowship – *$1,000* Awarded Feb. 2020, Jan. 2019
Strategic Investment Fund – University of Virginia
Funding to present at SRCD 2020 Special Topics Meeting/2019 Biennial Meeting

Student/Trainee Award – *$500* Awarded May 2018
International Society for Autism Research (INSAR)
Funding to present on panel at INSAR 2018 meeting in Rotterdam, Netherlands

Graduate Trainee Scholarship Recipient – *$500* Awarded Nov. 2016
Patient-Centered Outcomes Research Institute (PCORI)
Funding to attend PCORI Annual Meeting 2016 and Early Career Preconference

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Predoctoral Clinical Psychology Intern, June 2022 – June 2023
School Mental Health Track, APPIC #134716 (APA-approved site)
National Center for School Mental Health, University of Maryland School of Medicine
Baltimore, MD

Matched via APPIC system as the National Center for School Mental Health's pre-doctoral psychology intern in the VA Maryland Health Care System/University of Maryland School of Medicine Psychology Internship Consortium. UM SOM is the only American Psychological Association-accredited psychology internship that offers comprehensive major rotation experiences in school mental health practice, research, and policy with a goal of preparing scientist-practitioners to work in schools directly with vulnerable and underserved populations. Three days per week, I managed a school-based mental health clinic at Dickey Hill Elementary/Middle School in Baltimore City Public Schools. One day per week, I conducted outpatient psychological assessments for children and adolescents often experiencing trauma-related stressors such as housing and food instability, community violence, poverty, and interpersonal and institutionalized racism. And for the remainder of the week, I supported federally-funded research and policy activities within the National Center for School Mental Health's research division.

School-Based Clinical Psychology Extern, August 2021 – June 2022
Center for Wellbeing in School Environments (WISE Center)
Department of Psychiatry, MedStar Georgetown University Hospital
Washington, DC

I participated in a year-long externship for advanced doctoral students at MedStar Georgetown Center for Wellbeing in School Environments (WISE Center), housed

within Georgetown University's Department of Child Psychiatry. As an extern, I served DC public and public charter schools (elementary through high school) through mental health consultation and trauma-informed direct intervention. Most of the students we worked with lived in communities of poverty and experience chronic adverse childhood events (i.e., Wards 7 and 8). The mission of our hospital-school partnership was to expand access to high-quality, multidisciplinary school-based experts in direct clinical service and trauma-informed whole-school programming.

Advanced Practicum Student, July 2020 – May 2021
Virginia Treatment Center for Children (VTCC), Children's Hospital of Richmond @ VCU
Richmond, VA

As a psychology practicum student in the Acute Inpatient Program, I participated in multidisciplinary teams and served as a co-therapist for child and adolescent patients, often with complex trauma histories. As a co-therapist, I contributed to a mini-team of mental health professionals, providing intensive individual, group, and family therapy, consulted with psychiatrists for rapid diagnostic and psychopharmacologic assessment, and developed and implemented effective treatment programs and discharge plans. I was also responsible for behavior management consultation, crisis stabilization, community liaison work, case management, and family advocacy leading to enrollment in community services.

Parent Group Therapist, PEERS® for Young Adults, January 2021 – April 2021
Sheila C. Johnson Center, University of Virginia
Charlottesville, VA

In conjunction with the Supporting Transformative Autism Research (STAR) Initiative at the University of Virginia, I served as a group therapist for the "social coaches" of young adults (ages 18 – 30) participating in a 16-week social skills intervention for motivated young adults with autism spectrum disorder, who were interested in learning skills to make and keep friends and develop romantic relationships. Young adults attended each session with a social coach (e.g., parent, family member, adult sibling, life coach, job coach, peer mentor, etc.) Social coaches were taught how to assist young adults in making and keeping friends by providing feedback during weekly socialization homework assignments.

Group Administrator, Conversations About Race and Equity, August 2021 – May 2022
Group Therapist, Conversations About Race and Equity, January 2020 – May 2021
School of Education and Human Development, University of Virginia
Charlottesville, VA

Served as a group therapist each semester for Conversations About Race and Equity (CARE), a 6-week therapy group for undergraduate and graduate pre-service professionals. The primary goal of CARE is to help students understand and process the historical and ongoing sociopolitical and systemic causes, mechanisms, consequences, and solutions to widespread racism in the United States. The CARE curriculum includes six 90-minute sessions per semester that are designed to create an environment that is promotive of meaningful conversations about diversity, racial equity, and social justice; enhance participants' capacity and comfort working with diverse populations; and share

individual experiences with race and privilege. We also hope that participants come away with increased cultural and racial self-awareness and appreciation for new perspectives, in order to engage in the world in a way that leverages privilege and promotes inclusion and equity.

Psychology Associate Clinician, July 2019 – June 2022
Sheila C. Johnson Center, University of Virginia
Charlottesville, VA

As a student clinician, I provided psychoeducational assessments and psychological intervention services at the Sheila C. Johnson Center, a multidisciplinary clinic housed in the University of Virginia's School of Education and Human Development. I received weekly individual (1:1) and group supervision for all psychotherapy cases. My caseload consisted of child-, adolescent-, and family-oriented cases; I assessed and supported the treatment of children with externalizing behaviors, obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD), depression, mood disorders, generalized anxiety, attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), learning disorders, and trauma-related challenges. I have significant interests collaborating with families, schools, and related-service providers through a multisystemic lens to provide effective, evidence-based treatments.

School Psychology Practicum Student, January 2019 – May 2019
Orange County Public Schools
Orange, VA

Supervised by school psychologist, Heather Joyce, Ed.S., NCSP. An eight hours/week school-based practicum experience under the supervision of a field supervisor. One hour a week was spent writing or in other preparation activities (e.g., writing observational summaries, writing cognitive assessment reports). Practicum students participated in a range of activities typically expected of a school psychologist (e.g., assessment, intervention, consultation, special education procedural activities).

Co-Leader, Gender & Autism Group, February 2017 – June 2018
Children's National Health System
Rockville, MD

Co-led a monthly support group designed specifically for children and adolescents who have both autism spectrum disorder and gender dysphoria. Youth who identified as both neurodivergent and gender variant attended the youth group while their parents attend a simultaneous parental support group. Duties included collaborating with neuropsychology externs to supervise and counsel youth in sharing their unique experiences, exploring gender preferences, and learning from the experiences of guest speakers from across the country.

Co-Leader, Transition to Adulthood Group, February 2017 – April 2017
Children's National Health System
Rockville, MD

Coordinated with Dr. John Strang to provide long-term group therapy for adolescents and young adults with ASD working toward complete independence in adulthood. Conducted hands-on activities to build independence such as mock job interviews and planned

community outings. Engaged in weekly treatment planning meetings with Dr. Strang and his neuropsychology externs.

Lead Social Learning Teacher, June 2015 – July 2016
Assistant Social Learning Teacher, June 2014 – July 2014
Take2 Camp
Washington, DC

Oversaw the elementary program of a therapeutic summer camp for children, ranging from 7 - 14 years old, with social learning disabilities, including but not limited to ASD. Supervised and implemented instructional programs, supported implementation of behavioral programs, and coordinated with other support staff. Communicated with service providers and parents through regular staff meetings, parent-communication journals, and parent-teacher conferences. Formal reports, including individualized recommendations, were written for each camper at the conclusion of camp.

Summer Group Leader, June 2012 – July 2012
The Lab School of Washington
Washington, DC

Supported the social-emotional needs of twelve campers with various neurodevelopmental disorders throughout the 5-week summer program for children who exhibit learning differences. Accompanied children to their scheduled classes and assisted teachers in Tutoring, Team-Building, Academic Clubs and Art, and Movement. Received college credit for independent study for this unpaid internship.

Certifications

- Attachment, Regulation, and Competency (ARC) Trauma Treatment for Children and Adolescents
- Bounce Back Intervention Certification, 3C Institute
- Cognitive Behavioral Intervention for Trauma in Schools (CBITS) Certification
- Trauma-Focused Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (TF-CBT) Web 2.0 Certification
- Collaborative Assessment & Management of Suicidality (CAMS TRAINED)
- Columbia-Suicide Severity Protocol, The Columbia Lighthouse Project

  Therapeutic Options of Virginia (TOVA) Certification - *Neurorelational Behavior Support and Emergency Behavior Management*

Assessment Measures

- **Intelligence and Achievement**
  - Comprehensive Test of Phonological Processing – Second Edition (CTOPP-2)
  - Differential Ability Scales-II (DAS-II)
  - Nelson-Denny Reading Test, Forms I & J (NDRT)
  - Qualitative Reading Inventory – Sixth Edition (QRI-6)
  - Wechsler Abbreviated Scale of Intelligence – Second Edition (WASI-II)
  - Wechsler Individual Achievement Test – Third Edition (WIAT-III)
  - Wechsler Intelligence Scale for Children – Fifth Edition (WISC-V)

    - Wechsler Preschool & Primary Scale of Intelligence – Fourth Edition (WPPSI-IV)
    - Woodcock Johnson IV: Tests of Achievement (WJ-IV Ach.)
    - Woodcock Johnson IV: Tests of Cognitive Abilities (WJ-IV Cog.)
    - Woodcock Johnson IV: Tests of Oral Language Abilities (WJ-IV OL)
- **Semi-Structured Interviews**
    - MINI International Neuropsychiatric Interview, Sec. W (ADHD) – Version 5.0
    - Vineland Adaptive Behavior Scales, Second Edition (Vineland™-II)
- **Executive Function**
    - A Developmental NEuroPSYchological Assessment (NEPSY-II)
    - Behavioural Assessment of the Dysexecutive Syndrome (BADS)
    - Delis-Kaplan Executive Functioning System (DKEFS)
    - Rey Complex Figure Test and Recognition Trial (RCFT)
    - Tower of London-Drexel (TOL-DX)
- **Psycho-Diagnostic**
    - Autism Diagnostic Observation Schedule, Second Edition (ADOS-2)
    - Conners Continuous Performance Test, 3rd Edition (CPT-3)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

EDHS Clinical and School Psychology Lecturer, January 2024 – May 2024
EDHS 8670: Behavioral, Emotional and Social Assessment of Children, University of Virginia
Instructor of Record: Meredith P. Franco, PhD

Taught the course, *Behavioral, Emotional and Social Assessment of Children*, in Spring 2024. We covered the theory and research associated with the use of assessment methods and measures. In addition, the course provided opportunities for students to apply the knowledge gained from the course to improve their skill in conducting comprehensive psychological assessments of children and adolescents.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, August 2020 – December 2020
EDHS 2895: Mental Health in Schools, University of Virginia
Instructor of Record: Michael Lyons, Ph.D.

Provided instructional and grading support for *Mental Health in Schools* undergraduate course. Worked in partnership with Dr. Lyons to provide an overview of how school mental health professionals identify students in need of additional academic or mental health support, promote academic and psychological well-being, and assess outcomes.

Special Education Teacher, August 2015 – June 2016
Special Education Intern, August 2014 – May 2015
Special Education Extern, October 2013 – May 2014
Montgomery County Public Schools

Chaired Individual Education Program (IEP) meetings to determine eligibility for, and coordination of, special education and related services for students with disabilities. Monitored and evaluated educational outcomes through instructional data collection and assessment delivery. Provided direct instruction in self-contained and co-teaching models, which involved adapting instructional programs and materials. Conducted functional behavioral assessments (FBAs) and developed subsequent Behavior

Intervention Plans (BIPs). Trained in School-Wide Positive Behavior Intervention & Supports (SWPBIS).

ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT AWARDS

2022 Raven Society Scholarship – *$1,000* Awarded May 2022
The Raven Society – University of Virginia
Recognized for outstanding achievement in the classroom, unique achievement in scholarship outside the classroom, and leadership and community service during time at UVA

Odelia Moore Scholarship – *$1,000* Awarded Aug. 2021
UVA School of Education and Human Development Foundation
Scholarship awarded to a School of Education and Human Development student with demonstrated need

Reeve Loper Scholarship – *$1,000* Awarded Aug. 2019
Curry School of Education Foundation
Awarded based upon exceptional promise as evidenced by both professional and academic accomplishments

Clarvit Scholar in Special Education – *$3,000* Awarded Aug. 2012
Nancy and Chuck Clarvit Scholarship Fund
Support for outstanding undergraduate studying special education

WCCC Merit Scholarship – *$3,000* Awarded Apr. 2011
The Women's Club of Chevy Chase, Inc.
Support for local student demonstrating financial need and academic excellence

POLICY EXPERIENCE

ASPE Summer Policy Fellow, June 2021 – September 2021
Early Childhood Team, Human Services Policy
Office of the Assistant Secretary for Planning and Evaluation (ASPE)
U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
Supervisors: Jennifer Tschantz, Ph.D. and Cheri Hoffman, Ph.D.

Start with Equity Fellow, August 2020 – September 2021
Children's Equity Project, Arizona State University
Supported by the Heising-Simons Foundation
Policy Mentors: Shantel Meek, Ph.D. and Rosemarie Allen, Ed.D.

RACIAL EQUITY & ANTI-BIAS TRAININGS & WORKGROUPS

Racial Equity Groundwater Training by the Racial Equity Institute (REI)
November 6, 2020, Virtual Presentation
May 1, 2019, Charlottesville, VA

Twice attended this participatory workshop during which REI organizers used stories and data to present a perspective that racism is fundamentally structural in nature—meaning issues of race and racism permeate governmental, educational, financial, and other systems, causing racial inequity.

"Moving the Needle on Disproportionality" 2-Day Workgroup
October 4 – 5, 2019, Charlottesville, VA

Participated as a student researcher at this small workgroup of about twenty applied researchers from around the country. We aimed to focus on the two related issues of 1) the measurement of disproportionality and culturally responsive practices in applied policy, practice, and research contexts, and 2) school-based interventions focused on the discipline gap and the promotion of culturally responsive, inclusive, and equitable experiences of positive climate and discipline. I participated as a student researcher under the mentorship of research advisor, Catherine Bradshaw.

PRESS / MEDIA COVERAGE

News in Brief: EHD Alumna, Researcher Wins Outstanding Dissertation Award (2024, August 30) School of Education and Human Development | University of Virginia. https://education.virginia.edu/news-stories/news-brief-ehd-alumna-researcher-wins-outstanding-dissertation-award

Clinical-School Psychology Grad Student Lands Equity Fellowship. (2020, September 10). School of Education and Human Development | University of Virginia. https://education.virginia.edu/news/clinical-school-psychology-grad-student-lands-equity-fellowship

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Peer Reviewer *(alphabetically listed)*:

- *Journal of Autism and Developmental Disorders*
- *Journal of Research on Adolescence*
- *McGill Journal of Education*
- *Review of Education*
- *Social and Emotional Learning: Research, Practice, and Policy*
- *Studies in Educational Evaluation*

Book Reviewer, *Teachers College Record*
NASP Student Leader, 2019 – 2020, National Association of School Psychologists
Graduate Research Mentor, Student Undergraduate Research Program, UVA

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), 2018 – Present
American Psychological Association (APA), 2016 – Present

- Division 53: Society of Clinical Child and Adolescent Psychology

- Division 56: Trauma Psychology
- Division 16: School Psychology
    - **Committee Member (2025-2027)**, Outstanding Dissertation Award Committee, DIV16 – Education, Training, and Scientific Affairs

National Association for School Psychologists (NASP), 2019 – Present
Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (ABCT), 2017 – 2020
Association for Psychological Science (APS), 2016 – 2019
International Society for Autism Research (INSAR), 2016 – 2018
Council for Exceptional Children (CEC), 2013 – 2016
National Education Association (NEA), 2012 – 2014

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Running Start Network Mentor, Washington, DC, September 2019 – December 2020
Mentored girls and young women seeking counsel regarding leadership, teamwork, and career aspirations

Student Disability Access Center, Charlottesville, VA, August 2018 – December 2018
Provided class notes to masters- and doctoral-level students with documented disabilities

Medical Assistance Liaison, Chevy Chase, MD, February 2015 – June 2016
Ensured Medicaid compliance for low-income families of children with disabilities

TECHNOLOGY & LANGUAGE PROFICIENCIES

Research Technology:

- Qualtrics Online Survey Software **|** REDCap (Research Electronic Data Capture)
- IBM SPSS Statistics 28.0 **|** STATA/IC Statistical Software 18.0 **|** Mplus Version 8.6
- The Observer® XT by Noldus **|** Pendragon Software
- Zotero Reference Management Software
- Virtual Data Enclave (VDE), Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research

Languages:

- Intermediate Spanish (Latin American; Spanish WebCAPE Score: 536)
- English (Native Speaker)

REFERENCES

Research:

University of Virginia
Dr. Catherine Bradshaw, Research Mentor, Catherine.Bradshaw@virginia.edu
Dr. Jessika Bottiani, Research Co-Mentor, Jessika.Bottiani@virginia.edu

Children's National
Dr. Lauren Kenworthy, Division Chief, Neuropsychology,
lkenwort@childrensnational.org

Clinical – Outpatient:

Sheila C. Johnson Center, University of Virginia
Dr. Julia Blodgett, Assessment Supervisor, jab2h@virginia.edu
Dr. Matthew Yoder, Director of Clinical Training, msy7m@virginia.edu

Clinical – Inpatient:

Virginia Treatment Center for Children, Children's Hospital of Richmond at VCU
Dr. Leslie Kimball, Clinical Supervisor, leslie@richmondcreativecounseling.com

Clinical – School-Based:

National Center for School Mental Health (NCSMH)
Dr. Nancy Lever, Co-Director of NCSMH, nlever@som.umaryland.edu

MedStar Georgetown Center for Wellbeing in School Environments (WISE)
Dr. Megan Polanin, Co-Director of Clinical Training, meganp@medstarwise.org